



Australian Government

STUDY
AUSTRALIA



Your first week in Australia

These handy tips will help you get set up and settle into your new life in Australia as an international student.

[← Plan your move >](#)



Set up your Unique Student Identifier

If you plan to study at a university in Australia, attend TAFE or do any other nationally recognised training [🔗](#), you will need a Unique Student Identifier (USI). With a USI, you can get your qualification or statement of attainment.

You can only create a USI after you have arrived in Australia and cleared customs using your non-Australian passport and Australian visa as forms of ID. Once you have both documents, you can create your USI online by following the step-by-step instructions on the website.

You should obtain your USI as soon as possible after arriving in Australia so that you can provide it to your education or training provider.

For more information, visit usi.gov.au. [🔗](#)

Set up your phone

If you bring an unlocked phone to Australia, you can choose between a pre-paid service or a SIM-only plan.

Pre-paid SIM cards are sold in many shops and supermarkets as well as mobile phone provider stores. You can top up your prepaid service online or at various retail outlets.

If your phone is locked to your home provider, you may need to buy a new phone in Australia. Most providers will allow you to pay off your phone as part of your monthly contract. Your contract will also include a set allowance for calls, text messages

and data.

Open a bank account

To open a bank account, visit bank branch in Australia and tell them you are an international student wanting to open an account.

To open an account, you will need:

- electronic Confirmation of Enrolment (eCoE)
- passport, and
- proof of your address in Australia (such as a phone bill or lease agreement).

You should get a Tax File Number (TFN) and submit it to the bank. You don't need it to open your account, but without one, you will be taxed at a higher rate. You can find information about getting a TFN at the [Australian Tax Office](#) website.

Inform your education provider of your address

As per [visa condition 8533](#), you must inform your education provider of your residential address within seven (7) days of arriving in Australia. Find out more about [accommodation](#) in Australia.





Get familiar with your



WORK OPTIONS

Work while you study

Working while you study is a great way to gain experience, build networks and enjoy the local culture.



Each state or territory in Australia has a transport network. It's



LIFE IN AUSTRALIA

• **Student Support Services**

- Australia offers a wide range of student services,
- such as academic, language, housing, legal and careers support.



Most of these sites also have helpful apps you can download to your phone.



YOUNG LIFE IN AUSTRALIA

• **Accommodation**

Australia has a wide range of short-term, rental, on-campus and homestay accommodation options for students.

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Getting around by bicycle (bike) is a great way to save money and stay fit!

You can buy a new bike at a store or a second-hand one online through websites and apps such as Facebook Marketplace.

Quick links

Make sure you research the cycling rules for your state or territory to avoid any accidents or fines.

→ [Why Australia](#)

→ [Living costs](#)

Driving

→ [Australian study locations](#)

→ [Agent Hub](#)

Most Australian states and territories (the exception being the

Northern Territory) allow student visa holders to drive with their overseas licence as long as it is current. When driving, you must carry your overseas licence with you at all times, with either an international driving permit or an accredited English translation if your licence is not in English. It's a good idea to check the licensing rules in your state or territory to avoid a fine.

Find a course [Q](#)
It's also important to familiarise yourself with Australian road rules to keep yourself and your passengers safe.

[Follow Us](#)

Explore your new home

Finally, have fun exploring and getting to know your new location in Australia. There are so many adventures to be had in your new home! [Subscribe to our newsletter](#) [Q](#) All the latest student stories, blog posts and updates on student visas and travel to Australia straight to your inbox.

[Sign Up](#)



In the spirit of reconciliation we acknowledge the Traditional Custodians of country throughout Australia and their

connections to land, sea and community. We pay our respect to their elders past and present and extend that respect to all Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples today.

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